Find Longest

Ordinarily the matching engine will find the shortest match for sub-pattern, but the `l` option inverts this:

```
mb_ereg_search_init('apples and pears and apples and pears');
print mb_ereg_search_regs('(?:apples|pears|and| )+?')[0] . PHP_EOL;
mb_ereg_search_setpos(0);
print mb_ereg_search_regs('(?:apples|pears|and| )+?', 'l')[0];
```

```
Output:
apples
 and apples and pears
```

Note the leading space with the second match (and although it's difficult to see, there will be a trailing space too).

Ignore Empty

We saw the effect that the `PREG_SPLIT_NO_EMPTY` flag had on `preg_split()` earlier in this section. The `n` option has a similar effect, demonstrated below:

```
mb_ereg_search_init('@@@ abc');
print_r(mb_ereg_search_pos('[abc]*'));
print_r(mb_ereg_search_pos('[abc]*', 'n'));
```

```
Output:
Array
(
    [0] => 0
    [1] => 0
)
Array
(
    [0] => 4
    [1] => 3
)
```